Gertrude said, "Oh hell!," got a broom, and disposed of the mouse herself. She was very angry with Putchikl for the rest of the day.

Doctor of Philosophy

My dissertation was coming along slowly but steadily. I kept thinking of new ways of describing the manner in which the enzyme lost its activity as it worked, and every once in a while I had to run more tests under new conditions to test this facet or other.

It was the job situation that upset me and I grew more and more uneasy as the weeks passed.

Then, on January 20, 1948, a new opening arrived from a totally unexpected direction: Elderfield approached me. Elderfield!

For over eight years I had considered him the leading anti-Asimovian in the department, the one who above anyone else was convinced that I was not doctoral material. Yet without warning he offered me a postdoctoral position as his assistant.

It was the sort of job that had seemed possible with Brand, but Elderfield offered me $4,500 a year, more than I would have had the nerve to ask. I was to work forty hours a week, have two to three weeks' vacation, have technicians under me, and a good, solid problem.

Elderfield was working on antimalarials at the time. During World War II, malaria was a serious problem for soldiers in tropical climates. In fact, it was the most deadly disease in the world in that there were more people suffering and dying from malaria the world over than from any other serious ailment.

The chemical used to control malaria was quinine, but during the war, the Japanese controlled the main sources of quinine for a while and the Americans had to develop artificial antimalarials, synthetic chemicals that would do the work of quinine.

This had been done successfully, and Elderfield had worked on the problem. Now he was anxious to turn to the theoretical end—to find out why synthetic antimalarials worked and to use this knowledge to design an antimalarial that would work better than any other, and better than quinine, too.

I was tempted, even though I didn't know that I could get along with Elderfield, because the problem seemed interesting. I talked to Morris